



INTERIOR DESIGNER

JOB DESCRIPTION

An interior designer shapes the look and feel of living and working spaces in homes, offices, stores, hotels, and other buildings. They may work on their own or alongside other professionals, such as architects and contractors, to create interiors that are both functional and attractive. Their work may range from advising on structural alterations to helping to select and coordinate furnishings, color schemes, and lighting.



SALARY

Junior interior designer ★★☆☆☆

Consultancy partner ★★★★★

INDUSTRY PROFILE

Demand for interior designers rising steadily • Main employers include design consultancies and architectural practices • Self-employment common among interior designers

AT A GLANCE



YOUR INTERESTS Interior design • Architecture • Design technology • Drawing • Arts and crafts • Materials • Sciences • Mathematics



ENTRY QUALIFICATIONS Relevant training is required in order to practice. Union membership may also be required to work on larger projects.



LIFESTYLE The work is often demanding and may require long or irregular hours to complete a job to a set deadline.



LOCATION Interior designers work in their clients' homes, in an office, or at industrial sites. They may also have to attend exhibitions and trade fairs.



THE REALITIES Clients can be unreasonable if their vision differs from that of the interior designer. Competition for work is fierce.

CAREER PATHS

A degree-level art or design qualification is often required to become an interior designer. Before you practice, you may also need to become a member of a professional design body. With experience, you can specialize in areas such as lighting and furniture.

ASSISTANT You may start by working alongside an established designer, sourcing materials or producing mood boards—used to illustrate the style a designer is trying to achieve. To progress, you will need to study for a degree or certificate on the job.



GRADUATE A degree or other higher-level qualification in design, architecture, or art history is required to work in some companies.

